

This can be useful; for instance, as an administrator, you can redirect all URLs in the “Game / Social sites” category to the company policy page (which states that such activities are not expected during working hours) for a subtle effect. Or you can ban sites under “Gambling / Porn sites” directly with a response that gives a stern warning that each access attempt is logged.

After a category is added, clicking on Manage Category Details allows you to add, modify, or delete the URLs for that category.

## 12.4 Summing It Up

All in all, what we’ve described above is a very good piece of software, and for something that is free, it can’t get much better than this. Of course, it does have its own share of bugs (this is free software, after all), and with some of them getting fixed with every subsequent release, it might require you to upgrade every time a new version is out. But then, bugs exist everywhere, and this seems a small price to pay for software such as this.

## 12.5 Squid

---

Squid is a multi-functional HTTP proxy and a Web cache released under the GNU GPL that is used to optimise Web traffic and improve network performance. Squid acts as a sort of agent, accepting requests from clients and forwarding them to the Web servers. While any proxy server can do just that, the magic of Squid lies in the way it stores a copy of the requested data onto disk so that the next time the same information is requested, it fetches it directly from disk instead of requesting the Web server for it, ultimately resulting in improved Web traffic and better bandwidth utilisation.

### 12.5.1 A Bit Of History

Squid traces its origins back to the early ‘90s, and was originally based on the Harvest Cache Daemon, in development during that time. The Squid project was then funded by a grant from the National Science Foundation, and developed by a team led by